



HUNTER

THE RECKONING



CHARACTER CREATION

QUICK REFERENCE



TABLE OF CONTENTS

1 – Table of Contents
2 – Hunter Lexicon
3 – Using the Dice
4 – Character Creation
6 – Advantages and Flaws
12 – Edges and Perks
15 – Experience Points & Character Progression
16 – Relationship Map
17 – Conflicts & Combat
19 – Credits



HUNTER LEXICON

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.10)

Cell: A group of **Hunters**, likely of multiple different creeds, united in the interests of protection, teamwork, and common cause.

Cellie: A fellow member of a **cell**; a few **Hunters** recognize the irony of it also being slang for a prison cellmate.

Coalition: A multinational joint task force of **orgs** dedicated to the eradication of supernatural threats and the preservation of order.

Drive: The reason a **Hunter** hunts, the motivation that drives and dictates their actions.

Creed: An outlook or approach a **Hunter** takes to reclaiming the world from supernatural threats, around which a sort of community has emerged.

Desperation: The state of urgency or even anxiety in the **cell**. Desperation dictates the amount of **Desperation Dice** that an individual **Hunter** can add to their pool when calling upon their **Drive**. The higher the Desperation, the stronger both the **Hunter's Drives** and the risk for **Danger** and **Despair**.

(Tracker Rating 1-5)

Danger: The extent to which the **cell's** enemies are aware of the **cell's** actions, and the risk of the **cell** becoming a target. As **Danger** rises, the **Hunters** face greater challenges, as their enemies tighten security, draft additional servants, and eventually take direct action against the **Hunters**.

(Tracker Rating 1-5)

Hunt, the: The pursuit of an individual supernatural creature or group; one specific operation.

Jobber: An **org** hunter; someone who simply "does the job" and exhibits no individual **Drive**.

Org: A formal organization that exists to hunt monsters as a means to an end rather than for its own sake; **orgs** often support a status quo situation or preserve the power of elites (or themselves) and are generally larger and better resourced than individual **cells**.

Quarry, the: The target of an individual **Hunt**; one specific supernatural creature or group.

Reckoning, the: The urge to take back the world from supernatural predators, with the urgency of right now in particular; the feeling that the world is at its tipping point.



USING THE DICE

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.110)

USING THE HUNTER DICE: REGULAR DICE

Blank face = **1-5** = Failure

 = **6-9** = Success

 = **10** = Success, potential critical win

USING THE HUNTER DICE: DESPERATION DICE

 = **1** = Overreach or Despair (see p. 128)

Blank face = **2-5** = Failure

 = **6-9** = Success

 = **10** = Success, potential critical win

Players can add **Desperation Dice** to rolls whose circumstances relate to their Creed.

Desperation is a tracker that spans 1-5 boxes. It represents the state of urgency or even anxiety in the cell.

Rolling a “1” on at least one Desperation Die triggers Overreach or Despair. If the test was a win, the player can choose to either Overreach, keeping the win, or treat the test as a failure and enter Despair.

One or more “1” on a failed test always causes Despair; the player has no choice in the matter. Players may not use Willpower to reroll Desperation Dice.

**If you roll an even number of 10s, you get a Critical Success and the Blue Successes double.*

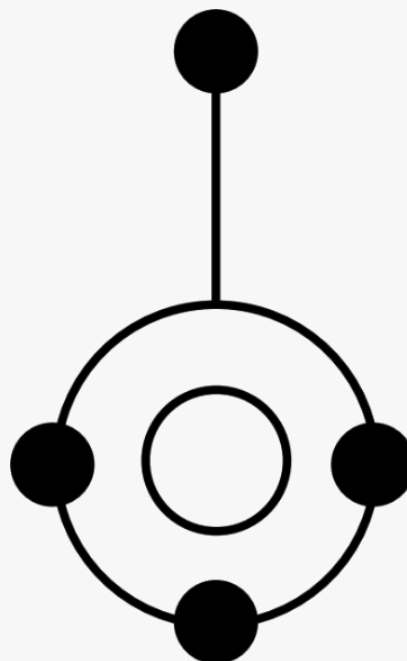
E.g. If you roll 2 10s, they count as 4 successes. 4 10s count as 8. And so on and so forth.

OVERREACH

For each “1” on the Desperation Dice, increase Danger by 1. The Hunter has in some way revealed themselves and their cell to the quarry, in a manner consistent with their Drive. The test is still considered a win, but the long-term consequences are potentially disastrous for the cell as a whole.

DESPAIR

The test fails no matter the amount of successes rolled and the Hunter enters a state of Despair, in which they are unable to call upon their Drive to use Desperation Dice until they’ve redeemed themselves in their own eyes. Each Drive has a different condition for redemption. The condition doesn’t have to be met by any specific individual in the cell — it can be treated as a group effort.





CHARACTER CREATION

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.54)

Summary

Choose Concept, Ambition, Desire, and Touchstones Choose Creed and Drive

Allocate Attributes

- Take one Attribute at 4; three Attributes at 3; four Attributes at 2; one Attribute at 1
- Record Health (Stamina + 3) and Willpower (Composure + Resolve)

Allocate Skills

Skill Distributions:

- Jack of all trades: One Skill at 3; eight Skills at 2; ten Skills at 1
- Balanced: Three Skills at 3; five Skills at 2; seven Skills at 1
- Specialist: One Skill at 4; three Skills at 3; three Skills at 2; three Skills at 1

Specialties

Characters receive one free specialty during character creation to apply to any Skill, and add one free specialty to Academics, Craft, Performance, and Science each.

Using a specialty on a test adds one die to the die pool. Multiple specialties cannot be used on a single test.

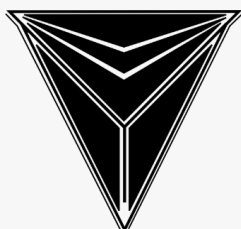
Allocate Advantages

- 7 points of Advantages, 2 points of Flaws
- Choose Edges: 2 Edges and 1 Perk or 1 Edge and 2 Perks

Edges and Perks

During character creation, choose **two** Edges and **one** Perk, or **one** Edge and **two** Perks.

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.89)



Concept

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.54)

Your character concept is like a pitch: a high-level hook, your character's "thing." "Monster-hunting soldier-of-fortune" or "drug-addled revenge-seeker" or "Edward Snowden, but he exposes supernatural malfeasance." If you know the Hunter setting, you might have a concept that ties into a creed, Drive, Edge, etc.: "massively entitled Underground capo" or "generous Faithful-creed imam."

Ambition

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.55)

A character's Ambition keeps them acting and moving both every day and in the chronicle. It provides motivation for the player and story hooks for the Storyteller. An Ambition must be measurable in game terms ("My Ambition is to become a master of Medicine") or a concrete achievement in the world of the chronicle ("My Ambition is to have a home I can safely call my own").

If an Ambition is unlikely to happen or would end the chronicle if achieved, it can still provide rich story juice — it only needs to be theoretically achievable.

At the end of a session in which the character has actively worked toward their Ambition, they recover one point of Aggravated Willpower damage (see p.17).

Desire

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.55)

A desire functions as a short-term goal. It reflects less than a lifelong Ambition, but more than a momentary want. Each session, a character can select a Desire or keep their unfulfilled Desire from the previous session. Once per session, when the character definitively acts to further or accomplish their Desire, they may immediately recover one point of spent or damaged Willpower.

Touchstones

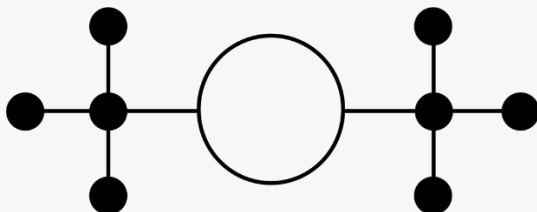
(H:TR 5E Core Book p.56)

For Hunters, the justification for the Reckoning and the Hunt becomes concrete in other people. These are the Touchstones who help them stay grounded, stay empathetic, and stay in touch with their communities or even just themselves. For Hunters, Touchstones are always people. These Touchstones have some personal connection to the Hunter and most probably have no knowledge of the supernatural. The relationship can be complex or simple or even one-sided.

Over the course of the chronicle, these Touchstones may be threatened and may even die. That's the point, though: They're the people the Hunter is fighting for, on a very individual, personal level.

Pick one to **three** Touchstones during character creation. More Touchstones means more risk, but also signifies a greater connection to the world and the people the Hunter loves.

A Hunter may replace a lost Touchstone or even replace a living one, but should do so in consultation with the Storyteller. Touchstones shouldn't be replaced on a whim; they're individuals with whom the Hunter has a deep connection or meaningful relationship.



Every Hunter has a creed and a Drive. Think of creed as their outlook —Drive is why they Hunt, their motivation.

Creeds (H:TR 5E Core Book p.57)

●**Entrepreneurial:** Bold innovations and experimental approaches.

Desperation Dice: Building, inventing, augmenting, or repairing while on the Hunt.

●**Faithful:** Belief in higher powers and a divinely informed worldview.

Desperation Dice: Any direct conflict (physical, social, or mental) with the supernatural while on the Hunt.

●**Inquisitive:** Gathering intel and understanding the quarry.

Desperation Dice: Gaining information while on the Hunt, such as research, breaking and entering, and interrogation.

●**Martial:** Attacking the supernatural via arms and tactics.

Desperation Dice: Physical conflict while on the Hunt (which need not be with the quarry itself, or even the supernatural).

●**Underground:** Guile, subterfuge, and knowing the right people.

Desperation Dice: Stealth and Subterfuge in service of the Hunt.

Drives (H:TR 5E Core Book p.56)

●**Curiosity:** What do monsters do, and why?

●**Vengeance:** Settle a score with the supernatural.

●**Oath:** A promise made binds the Hunter to honor it.

●**Greed:** Take the ill-gotten gains the monsters have stolen.

●**Pride:** The world belongs to humans, not the supernatural.

●**Envy:** Join the night or die trying.

●**Atonement:** Make up for aiding the supernatural in the past.



Advantages and Flaws

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.70)

In addition to unique Attributes and human skills, Hunters have many possible Advantages when they start play, from a knack with languages to a squad of sympathetic bat-swinging hooligans available on demand. Like everything else, we demarcate Advantages with dots, usually ranging from one to five. There is no penalty for having zero dots in an Advantage – that’s just normal.

Advantages are divided into Merits and Backgrounds. The flip side of Advantages, Flaws cause ongoing problems for the character.

Merits

Merits describe knacks, gifts, and just plain good fortune inherent to the character: Physical, Mental, and Social. Although something could happen during the game to change them – especially once weird inexplicable magic gets unleashed – characters’ Merits remain fairly constant over the course of the story

Example Merits & Flaws:

Linguistics

Every character is fluent in their birth language and (unless the player and Storyteller have a reason to declare otherwise) in the dominant language of the chronicle setting. Each dot in Linguistics allows the character to fluently speak, write, and read one additional language besides those two default languages. Note that reading centuries-old documents or chanting in a strange dialect may impose additional Difficulty to Academics or Occult tests.

Flaw: (••) Illiterate. You cannot read or write. Your Academics and Science Skills are capped at 1, and you can have no specialty in them incorporating modern knowledge.

Looks

Not all Hunters have the glamour of a cover model or iconic actor. Some of them look even better. And some, of course, look far worse. Looks modifiers apply only when you can be seen. The Storyteller rules whether these modifiers apply during Social conflicts on a conflict-by-conflict (or even pool-by-pool) basis.

- • Beautiful: You add one extra die to all appropriate Social dice pools.
- • • • Stunning: You add two extra dice to all appropriate Social dice pools, as above.

Flaw: (••) Repulsive: You lose two dice from all relevant Social dice pools. Flaw: (•) Ugly: You lose one die from all relevant Social dice pools

Nutritionist

You have a knack for making hearty, healthy meals that satisfy as well as being the stuff a body needs. Much as in a fire station, a good cook earns the appreciation of their fellow Hunters, and “family time” around the table helps keep many cells from becoming dysfunctional, especially against the odds they face each night.

- Solo Cooking: You personally recover one extra Superficial Health level at the beginning of a session that begins with you having had the opportunity to prepare a meal before the session begins.
- • Cell Chef: Your whole cell recovers one extra Superficial Health level at the beginning of a session that begins with you having had the opportunity to prepare a meal for them before the session begins.

Psychological Traits

The Reckoning is a stressful event, and the Hunt is a particularly demanding way to lead one’s life. Its risks take their toll on a Hunter’s mind or personality, to say nothing of those individuals whose personalities place them in jeopardy



even before they discover their purpose and Drive.

Flaw: (●●): Living on the Edge: You're one of those people who feel compelled to take every chance to experience life at its fullest. When you are confronted with a chance to indulge a risky temptation you haven't done before (such as snorting a new drug, imbibing vampire blood, or taking a changeling lover), you suffer a two-dice penalty to all actions until you either partake of the new experience or the scene ends. This Flaw won't compel you to undertake suicidal actions... but you may not always be able to accurately predict the consequences of your actions.

Flaw: (●●): Weak-Willed: You struggle to assert your own personality when confronted with the will of another. You may not necessarily be submissive; perhaps you feel more confident when following another person's lead. Even when you're aware of supernatural attempts to sway you mentally or emotionally, you may not use the active resistance systems to avoid those effects.

Substance Abuse

Unfortunately, many Hunters find themselves taking comfort in substances in order to cope with the grim reality of their world. With one of these Flaws, you have an addiction to a substance, perhaps even a supernatural one. Remember to specify the substance you use.

Flaw: (●) Addiction: Lose one dice from all pools when you did not indulge in your substance of choice during the last scene, except pools for actions that will immediately obtain your drug

Flaw: (●●) Severe Addiction: Lose two dice from all pools when you did not indulge in your substance of choice during the last scene, except pools for actions that will immediately obtain your drug.

Supernatural Situations

Hunters are occasionally touched by the supernatural themselves. These Merits and Flaws don't make the Hunter anything other than human, though they hint at a world in which lines of distinction between mortal and monster aren't so absolute

● ● Unseemly Aura: Something's different about the way certain supernatural creatures perceive you. Monsters occasionally believe you to be one of their own, or a supernatural creature of an entirely different (and possibly hostile) type. While it may lead the quarry to overestimate you, it could also lead to some awkward situations later down the line.

Flaw: (●) Stigmata: You bleed from open wounds on your hands, feet, and forehead when you suffer physical injury or Willpower damage (but not from spending Willpower). This attracts attention, leaves traces, and may penalize some dice pools at the Storyteller's discretion. Choose either Health or Willpower damage at character creation; this Flaw may be taken a second time for the other damage type, but, oh boy, are you asking for attention.

Flaw: (●●) Crone's Curse: Some supernatural affliction has affected you and aged you rapidly, such as a sorcerer's "evil eye" or having imbibed aberrant vampire blood. You appear at least a decade older than you are. In addition, your health has suffered, and you have one fewer box on your health tracker than you otherwise would.

However, Hunters who have either Merits or Flaws of this category don't count as monstrous or "Unnatural" for the purposes of Endowment Edges (*H:TR Core Book p.89*).



Backgrounds

Backgrounds describe advantages of relationship, circumstance, and opportunity: material possessions, social networks, and the like. Backgrounds are external Traits, not internal, and the player should always rationalize how the character came to possess them, as well as what they represent.

The same Background can be acquired multiple times.

Example Backgrounds & Flaws:

Allies

Allies are other people who support and help you: family, friends, or even a mortal organization that owes you some loyalty.

EFFECTIVENESS

- Weak individual, likely useless in a violent or potentially violent situation.
- ● Average individual or a tight-knit group of Weak individuals (neighborhood kids who solve mysteries, church group, NGO chapter)
- ● ● Gifted individual or a dangerous group of Average individuals (a street gang, a celebrity entourage, a blue-collar union local)
- ● ● ● Superlative individual, a Gifted individual with magic or other supernatural powers, or a well-armed group of Gifted individuals (a private security squad, a lawyer contingent, an org strike team).

RELIABILITY

- When you call on them, they appear half the time.
- ● When you call on them, they appear within 1-10 hours (roll a die).
- ● ● When you call on them, they appear as soon as possible.

Enemies are the opposite of Allies and are taken as Flaws. All Enemies are rated two fewer dots than their Effectiveness; a Gifted Ally costs three dots as an Ally, but only provides one dot as a Flaw.

You can use the Supporting Character Template rules to create Allies or Enemies when you buy them or first call on them.

Supporting Character Templates:

WEAK INDIVIDUAL (2/1)

Pools: Two key action pools at 2, three at 1
Advantages: None

AVERAGE INDIVIDUAL (3/2)

Pools: Two key action pools at 3, three at 2, four at 1
Advantages: up to 3 points (2 points maximum Flaws)

GIFTED INDIVIDUAL (4/2)

Pools: One key action pool at 4, two at 3, two at 2, two at 1
Advantages: up to 10 points (4 points maximum Flaws)

SUPERLATIVE INDIVIDUAL (5/3)

Pools: Two key action pools at 5, two at 4, two at 3, two at 2
Advantages: up to 15 points (no Flaws)

Fame

People know your name and eagerly seek out news of your activities. You might be a movie star, rock star, or other celebrity. Fame grants pull in mass and social media; you have more ways than most to manipulate the thoughts of the populace. You likely have ways to mask the fact that you're involved in things that you prefer to keep secret, such as a body double.

Fame has its downside, of course – it's harder for you to tail someone unobtrusively, for example, and who wants groupies hanging around the door to the cell safe house all day tagging its location on Instagram? You should look into taking Disguise as a Skill specialty.

- A select subculture knows who you are and admires you.



- ● You are a local celebrity, recognized by a plurality of the city.

- ● ● Most people in the country know your name, at least.

- ● ● ● Everybody who even vaguely cares about social trends or your field knows something about you.

- ● ● ● ● Your Fame reaches mass national or even global audiences. You are a major movie star, stadium-filling rock act, or former president.

Infamy (● ● Flaw): You are famous for something horrible. At the very least, the Difficulty of most reaction tests increases by the amount of the Flaw; at worst, the authorities attempt to kill or capture you whenever you appear. You may be on an org's Most Wanted list, or a rival to the sorcerer you brought to justice may have shared your description with others of her cabal.

Dark Secret (● Flaw): The Dark Secret Flaw provides one fewer point than the equivalent Infamy, as your black deeds remain unknown to all but you and perhaps one or two very motivated enemies. It's also easier to uncover than a truly life-threatening secret, such as a significant debt to a criminal or org member.

Infamous Partner (● Flaw): Your spouse, lover, or some other significant individual to you has Infamy (as above) that occasionally tarnishes you by association.

Mask

As individuals who must sometimes work in secrecy or with a degree of plausible deniability, Hunters find great value in being able to protect themselves with false identities. By default (at no dots) a Hunter either has no need of a Mask or has a viable fake ID that can stand up to a traffic stop or similar surface scrutiny. A zero-dot Mask does not pass a background check,

much less a proper investigation by the authorities.

- You have a good fake identity, including a credit card, bank account, credit history, birth certificate, etc., all in your Mask's name. You can pass a state or provincial-level background check.

- ● Your Mask can pass a background check with the national police: FBI, Scotland Yard, or the equivalent. If you had a military or intelligence record, it has been classified.

If you have a two-dot Mask, you can also buy the following Advantages for one dot each:

- Zeroed: Someone in high places has purged your real records. You officially don't exist.

- Cobbler: You can make or source Masks. Making a Mask takes three days per dot and possibly exposes you online; sourcing Masks takes one day per dot, but costs something in return. How much, the Storyteller depends on your leverage, margin on the Social test, or whatever else to decide.

Flaw: (● ●) Person of Interest: Your biometrics, name, history, known associates, and aliases appear in several intelligence agency databases, flagged as a potential terrorist. Any org operator (or comparable analyst) can probably put two and two together to realize what you've been up to.

Flaw: (●) Serial Error: Somewhere, someone made a mistake to your detriment. As a result, anyone who does a background check on you will learn that you died recently or are on a dangerous watchlist or are otherwise (unjustly) worthy of detention or a call to the police. (Of course, you may well be worthy of detention, just not for this particular reason.) This Flaw also applies to any database lookups on your identity



Safe House

Safe House represents a degree of security or distinction for one's domicile above and beyond a place to sleep and prepare meals. A Hunter with no dots in Safe House has a room in an abandoned motel, a rented office, an apartment with windows in various states of disrepair, or a van parked behind a disused machine shop

Hunters know their sanctums intimately. For each dot of base Safe House rating, add one per dot to dice pools to notice danger while in the domicile.

BASE SAFE HOUSE

- Small safe house, but more secure and private than the default. Examples: basement apartment, record shop backroom, locked storeroom in a warehouse.

- Good size, security, or privacy. Examples: a single-family home or townhome, converted downtown storefront, secure sewer tunnel.

- Very large, secure, or private. Examples: a compound outside town, a bank building, a decommissioned subway station.

Flaw: (●) No Safe House: You're not necessarily homeless, but you have no expectation of security while "at home. Examples include a squat with high traffic, a flat in a distressed part of town, or a malfunctioning "mobile" home.

SAFE HOUSE MERITS AND FLAWS

You can add Merits and Flaws to your Safe House if you wish. They stack with the base Safe House rating to produce the total dots in this Background for projects and other uses. Note that you can make Safe House a shared Background among your cell – easily the best way to afford a Safe House with lots of features.

- Hidden Armory: Each dot in this Merit adds a stand of basic, mundane arms to your safe house's supply: one pistol and one long firearm,

with ammunition. They are as secure from discovery as your resting place. These aren't as noteworthy as those provided by the Arsenal Edge, nor do they automatically replenish if misplaced.

- Panic Room: Your safe house has a dedicated, locked place to house two individuals with a base Difficulty to breach of 5. It can also be used to keep captives (in which case the breach difficulty becomes an escape Difficulty). Each extra dot either allows you to house twice as many individuals (up to a maximum of 32, only in very large safe houses) or adds +1 to the breach or escape Difficulty. This Merit is not available in small safe houses.

- Watchmen: Whether it's private security or criminal toughs, someone's guarding your safe house. Each dot of this Merit supplies four Average guards and one Gifted boss (*see Supporting Character Templates, p. 8*). If guards would be conspicuous here, buy this Merit cautiously. Note, too, that the guards aren't themselves Hunters, and are in fact probably entirely unfamiliar with the supernatural.

- Laboratory: Your safe house has an equipped laboratory with a dedicated industrial sink, gas jet, reinforced floor, etc. Each dot of this Merit adds one to the dice pool for rolls related to one Science or Technology specialty. This Merit is not available in small safe houses.

- Luxury: High-definition flat screens, designer furniture, memorable decor, or other distinctive details give you a two-dice bonus to Social tests dealing with guests in your safe house. If you don't have at least three dots of Resources (●●●), your décor was gained illegally.

- Postern: Your safe house has a rear exit, secret tunnel, grating in the cellar leading into the sewers, or other unobtrusive way out. For each dot of this Merit, add one die to your dice pools to evade or escape surveillance near your safe house.



- Security System: Your safe house has a better-than-average security system. For each dot of this Merit, add one die to your dice pool to resist (or alert you to) unauthorized entry into your safe house.

- Surgery: Your safe house has one room equipped as a field surgery or better. Add two dice to relevant dice pools, generally Medicine, for tests performed in your safe house. This Merit is not available in small safe houses.

Flaw: (●●) Compromised: Your safe house has been raided once before, perhaps even before it was yours. It probably appears on someone's watchlist. Invaders or spies can add two dice to their pool to penetrate or surveil your safe house.

Flaw: (●) Creepy: Your safe house looks like the lair of the sorts of supernatural horrors you ostensibly hunt, and you may have even "moved in" after dealing with one of them. Unknowing neighbors might phone in a tip to the cops or just talk about the creepy place they saw. Your dice pools on Social tests to seduce or otherwise put human guests at ease while in your safe house are at a two-dice penalty.

Flaw: (●) Haunted: Your safe house has a supernatural manifestation in it that you don't control or really even understand. It might have a ghost, but a Haunted safe house could hold a dimensional portal, a cursed meteorite, or anything else you can't get rid of. The risk is that someone who does understand the manifestation could use it to breach your safe house's security. The Storyteller defines any other effect of the haunting, imposing at least a relevant one-die penalty or bonus to affected pools used in the safe house per dot of Haunted taken as a Flaw.

Mentor

This Trait represents one or a group of Hunters who look out for you, offering guidance, information, or aid once in a while. Such a role may fall to an individual who helped initiate you into the ways of the Hunt (if you were fortunate enough to have such) or may be someone of the same creed or similar Drive.

As a general rule, Mentors provide a helpful word and occasional political pushes or cover, but they don't fight your battles or call in valuable favors. If they must CHAPTER TWO: CHARACTERS 77 do so for their own sake to aid you, you probably lose a dot or more of this Background, after arousing their ire.

- Rookie Hunter Mentor (one successful Hunt)

- Journeyman Hunter Mentor (perhaps three successful Hunts)

- Experienced Hunter Mentor (five or so successful Hunts)

- Veteran Hunter Mentor (holy smokes, nine or more successful Hunts)

- Van Helsing (how has this Hunter not yet met their demise?)

ADVERSARY

A rival Hunter who generally wishes you (or your cell, or perhaps even your Mentor) ill, an Adversary is the reverse Flaw of the Mentor Background. Adversaries range from one-dot elders to three-dot veterans or strike teams. The Storyteller uses either the Adversary's Status or some specific other Trait when building dice pools with which to oppose the player characters, not the dots in Adversary.

You can find more Advantages and Flaws in the [Hunter: The Reckoning 5E Core Book](#).



Edges and Perks

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.89)

Edges represent a wide variety of advantages that make a Hunter a cut above most people, at least in regard to hunting supernatural terrors. Edges do not have a rating, but players instead purchase additional Perks. Each Perk enhances the Edge in some way, adding to or changing its effect. Most Perks can be acquired only once, but some (such as creature specializations) can be learned multiple times, and there's no limit to the amount of Perks a Hunter can possess in a given Edge.

Edges are divided into three categories: Assets, Aptitudes and Endowments. These have no intrinsic rules associated with them, but they help classify and categorize the various edges.

Assets Example:

Arsenal

The Hunter has access to, or can jerry-rig, a wide variety of weapons not usually available to the public. These include both firearms and melee weapons, but not bombs, mines, or other munitions. Whether borrowed from an old contact or slapped together in a garage, the weapons are otherwise mundane and only available for a limited time. After that the weapons either need to be returned to whomever provided them, require extensive maintenance, or simply break down on account of being jerry-rigged.

EDGE POOL

Hunters who keep and maintain their own arsenal test Intelligence + Craft. Those who rely on contacts test Manipulation + Streetwise instead.

SYSTEM

On a winning test at Difficulty 4 the Hunter is able to provide a single personal firearm or melee weapon, such as a sniper rifle, handgun,

or high-steel combat blade. The test is made at the start of a scene, and the Hunter must have reasonable access to their supply cache or contact. (No win, no matter how critical, is going to produce a weapon in the midst of the Sahara.) The test can be attempted only once for each scene, and the weapon can be used only for that scene. Subsequent tests in later scenes can provide the same or similar weapon, though.

Arsenal Perks

- **Team Requisition:** The Hunter is able to provide additional copies of the same weapon up to the margin of the win. The weapons provided all have the same perks (if any) and are subject to the same limited duration.
- **Special Features:** The weapon provided comes with a number of special features up to the margin of the win. Features can range from thermal sights to disguised cases, and the Storyteller is the final arbiter on what qualifies as a feature for these purposes. Special features can be borrowed from some of the Equipment listings (H:TR 5E Core Book p.101), but players also have the option to suggest even more creative and unique solutions based on what they've learned about their cell's quarry in a particular Hunt.
- **Exotics:** Rare or one-of-a-kind weapons and ammunition can be procured. These range from silver bullets to things like pre-Olmec obsidian daggers. The Difficulty of the test increases in the case of really rare or unique weapons, as determined by the Storyteller. The armaments are not inherently supernatural but can exploit special vulnerabilities of the quarry (as with those silver bullets).
- **Untraceable:** The weapons procured are completely untraceable and will never lead authorities or prey to the Hunters by themselves.



Aptitudes Example:

Improvised Gear

By utilizing objects and materials in the near vicinity, the Hunter is able to devise any number of useful, if short-lived, tools to aid them or their comrades. Anything from a four-foot articulated periscope to splicing a surveillance camera's feed to a remote Bluetooth transmitter is possible, though the tool must be plausibly assembled from items available to the Hunter.

EDGE POOL

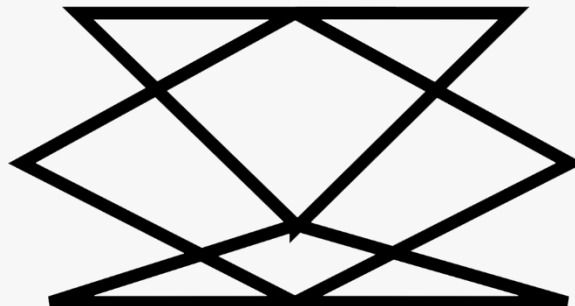
Intelligence + Craft, Technology, or Science, depending on the type of tool or substance desired.

SYSTEM

On a winning Edge test at Difficulty 4, the Hunter is able to create short-lived but helpful equipment from ordinary items. This equipment can assist in the use of a single Skill, providing a two-dice advantage. (The Storyteller is the final arbiter regarding which Skills can be augmented by equipment, and under what circumstances.) As well, it can make possible actions that simply wouldn't be possible otherwise, such as dumping camera footage to a cloud server or seeing over an obstacle. The creation can take anywhere from a few minutes to a couple hours, at the Storyteller's discretion, and not under duress such as during an ongoing firefight. Items created with this ability cease to function when the scene ends, and the Hunter can only create a single item each scene, unless they have the appropriate Perk.

Improvised Gear Perks

- **Frugal:** The Hunter is able to construct most items out of the trinkets and tools they carry, no matter how bare their location. This requires them to bring along a bag or other container of various bits and pieces, but as long as they bring it they can apply the Edge anywhere.
- **Mass Production:** The Hunter is able to create a number of additional items equal to the margin of the test. The items are all identical and augment the same Skill, and all other restrictions and Perks apply.
- **Specialization:** The Hunter can specialize in augmenting a particular Skill, providing a three-dice bonus instead of the regular two-dice bonus. This perk can be acquired multiple times, but only once for each Skill.
- **Speed Crafting:** Normally, this Edge cannot be used to improvise items under heavy duress, such as an ongoing physical conflict. With this Perk, the Hunter can craft a tool in three turns, minus the margin on the test, to a minimum of one turn, regardless of outside circumstances such as bullets flying.





Endowments Example:

These are abilities that, to the uninitiated, might appear as magic, divine intervention, or something superhuman. Whether they stem from a deep-rooted faith in the justness of Christ, folk-magic practices handed down through generations, or experimental anti-boson technology too volatile to be made public, Endowments cross the border into the supernatural, and those that employ them are often met with distrust by their fellow Hunters.

Artifact

Some rare Hunters possess a tool that for some reason — scientific, supernatural, spiritual, whatever — has properties that elevate it beyond items of similar ilk. Often, these are items from folklore or legend, inherited from generation to generation or unearthed through sheer accident. Sometimes they're even constructed by the Hunter themselves, employing forbidden knowledge or one-of-a-kind components that resist replication. An Artifact is a power in itself, making its wielder a force to be reckoned with.

EDGE POOL

Intelligence + Occult or Science, depending on the nature of the Artifact.

SYSTEM

At the basic level, the relic provides the Hunter with a one-dice bonus to a single Skill associated with it when used. A blessed scimitar would provide its bonus to melee, while a prismatically augmented loup provides the same bonus to Awareness. This bonus never applies to Edge tests for the Artifact. The Artifact can be used as an object of focus (see previous Endowment Edges) if it meets the requirements. If lost or destroyed the Hunter can always regain it, but it is likely to involve an ordeal of story-length proportions.

Artifact Perks

- **Empower:** Once per scene, the Hunter can make an Edge Test at Difficulty 4 to increase the Artifact's dice bonus to three dice. If the test fails, the Hunter suffers superficial Willpower damage equal to the number of successes by which they failed.
- **Attraction:** The Artifact is sought after by any number of supernatural parties. It can be used as bait, and provides a two-dice bonus to any ambush attempts, as the prey becomes blinded by their desire to possess it. The Hunter can choose to keep it secret to avoid attracting attention, but once revealed it continues to lure those who know of its location. Alternatively, instead of supernatural attention, the player may elect to have the Artifact attract the attention of the org from which it was purloined or liberated, such as for a high-tech prototype or a potent religious relic.
- **Detection:** The Artifact reacts to the presence of the supernatural, similar to the Sense the Unnatural Edge. The Hunter must achieve a win on an Edge test, with the Difficulty ranging from 3-5, depending on the type and power of the creature. The use has to be intentional, and the Hunter must hold (and possibly consult) the Artifact. Note that the power does not indicate who or what the creature is, only that it is close. Using the ability more than once per scene requires the expenditure of a point of Willpower for each additional attempt.
- **Shield:** The Artifact shields the Hunter from harm by supernatural forces. While it is on their person, any physical damage sustained from supernatural sources is halved. (Or halved again, in the case of superficial damage.)

You can find more Edges and Perks in the [Hunter: The Reckoning 5E Core Book](#).

Experience Points & Character Progression

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.82)

Hunters learn things over time as they're facing down the supernatural, or even in parallel to it. As their characters acquire experience points, players can spend those points on improving their characters' Traits. The experience point cost of a dot varies depending on what type of dot it is and how many dots you already have in that Trait. "New level" on the table below means the level of Trait you want to buy. For example, if you want to go from two dots of Composure (● ●) to three dots of Composure (● ● ●), you need to pay 15 experience points, because Composure 3 x 5 = 15.

Trait	Experience Points
Increase Attribute	New level x 5
Increase Skill	New level x 3
Specialty	3
Edge	7
Perk	3
Advantage	3 per dot

At the end of each session, the Storyteller should reward players with experience points to represent having learned something during that particular session.

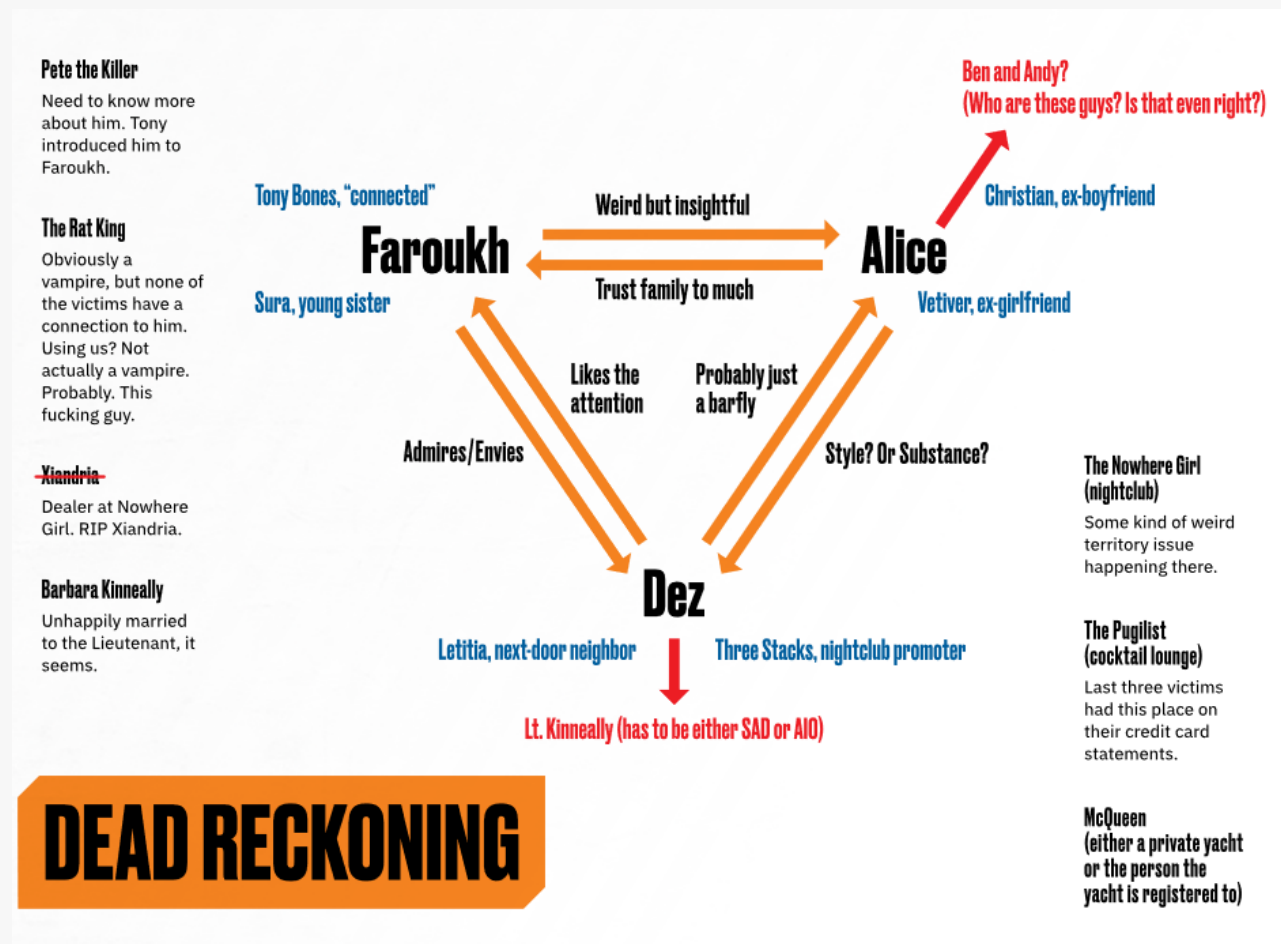
THE RELATIONSHIP MAP

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.84)

Hunter depicts dramatic action. Drama occurs between people, some of whom may be vampires. When two people interact, they create, reinforce, or change a relationship. By drawing a Relationship Map, you can bring drama visually to the forefront, keep track of supporting characters you've encountered, and provide both Storyteller and players with emotional substance for those interpersonal scenes.

By drawing a Relationship Map, you can bring drama visually to the forefront, keep track of supporting characters you've encountered, and provide both Storyteller and players with emotional substance for those interpersonal scenes.

During Session Zero, you begin the Relationship Map, possibly working in pencil at first. At this first core concept stage, draw in the player's characters, along with several relationships and supporting cast members



DEAD RECKONING

You can use whatever colors you have in a drawer or on the computer, but the Relationship Map example above from the H:TR Core Book p. 85 uses these:

- **Black** denotes player character names, locations, and notes.
- **Red** denotes fellow H/hunters and their strongholds and interests.
- **Blue** marks humans and their activities and bases.



CONFLICTS & COMBAT

Difficulty *(H:TR 5E Core Book p.112)*

The Difficulty is the number of successful dice required to accomplish a task. The target number for individual dice rolled is always 6 or higher.

Difficulty of Action	Number of Successes
Routine (striking a stationary target, convincing a loyal friend to help you)	1 success
Straightforward (aggravating someone who's already spoiling for a fight, intimidating a weakling)	2 successes
Moderate (leaping a gap between two rooftops, persuading a disinterested bus driver to hold the bus)	3 successes
Challenging (locating the source of a whisper, creating a memorable piece of art)	4 successes
Hard (convincing a cop that this isn't your cocaine, placating a hostile ghost)	5 successes
Very Hard (running across a tightrope while under fire, calming a hostile and violent mob)	6 successes
Nearly Impossible (finding one specific homeless person in Los Angeles in one night, flawlessly reciting a long text in a language you don't speak)	7 or more successes

Order of Combat

(H:TR 5E Core Book p.100)

WHO GOES FIRST?

This question mostly arises during physical combat — in debates, having the last word may be more valuable than dropping the first allegation.

Unless one side has surprise (usually resulting from a success on an earlier test, perhaps of tactics or sneaking to set up an ambush) characters, act in descending order of action:

- Close combat between already engaged parties, then
- Ranged combat, then
- Newly initiated physical combat, then
- Anything else that might be transpiring

If necessary, break ties by comparing Dexterity + Wits, or if equal, by dots of the Skill used.

Weapons *(H:TR 5E Core Book p.100)*

The dice pool each participant uses in a conflict turn is called their conflict pool. In a fight, the conflict pool might be Strength + Brawl or Composure + Firearms.

To calculate Damage, take the weapon's damage rating to the margin on the winning attack roll for the total damage inflicted.

(See "Conflict Pools" on p. 118 of the H:TR Core Book for more information on making attack rolls and determining damage.)

Weapon Damage	Value
Improvised weapon, stake*	+0
Light impact (brass knuckles)	+1
Heavy impact (baton, club, tire iron, baseball bat)	+2
Light piercing (crossbow bolt, switchblade)	
Light gunshot (.22 pistol)	
Heavy melee (broadsword, fire axe)	+3
Medium gunshot (.308 rifle (single-shot), 9 mm pistol, shotgun at effective range)	
Heavy gunshot (12-gauge shotgun (close range only), .357 Magnum)	+4
Huge melee (claymore, steel beam)	

Armor *(H:TR 5E Core Book p.100)*

Each point of armor changes 1 point of Aggravated damage from puncturing or bladed weapons (per damage roll) to Superficial damage, which is then halved as usual. This protection is in general only useful to humans (including Hunters), as many supernatural creatures already consider those types of damage Superficial.

Armor Type	Armor Value
Reinforced clothing/heavy leathers	2 (0 vs. firearms)
Ballistic cloth	2
Kevlar vest/flak jacket	4
Tactical SWAT/military armor (one-die penalty to Dexterity rolls)	6

You can find more Weapons, Armor, and Equipment in the [Hunter: The Reckoning 5E Core Book](#).



Healing *(H:TR 5E Core Book p.123)*

	HEALTH	WILLPOWER
Superficial Damage	At the beginning of a session, humans can remove a number of Superficial damage levels up to their Stamina rating from their Health tracker.	At the beginning of a session, humans can remove a number of Superficial damage levels up to their Composure or Resolve rating (use highest) from their Willpower track. Accomplishing one's short-term Desire also restores a single point of damaged or spent Willpower
Aggravated Damage	A character with Medicine can convert Aggravated damage into Superficial damage. They must succeed at an Intelligence + Medicine roll with Difficulty equal the total Aggravated damage sustained by the patient. Attempts to heal oneself add +1 to the Difficulty. The maximum points of Aggravated damage that a character can convert is half that character's Medicine rating, rounded up.	At the end of each session, a character who has acted in accordance to their Ambition (<i>see p. 4</i>) can heal 1 level of Aggravated Willpower damage.

Superficial Damage causes bruising, sprains, and the like but not immediate life-threatening injury. In social conflict, it may mean embarrassment, a bruised ego, or shaken confidence and has no lasting effect on the target's image of others or themselves.

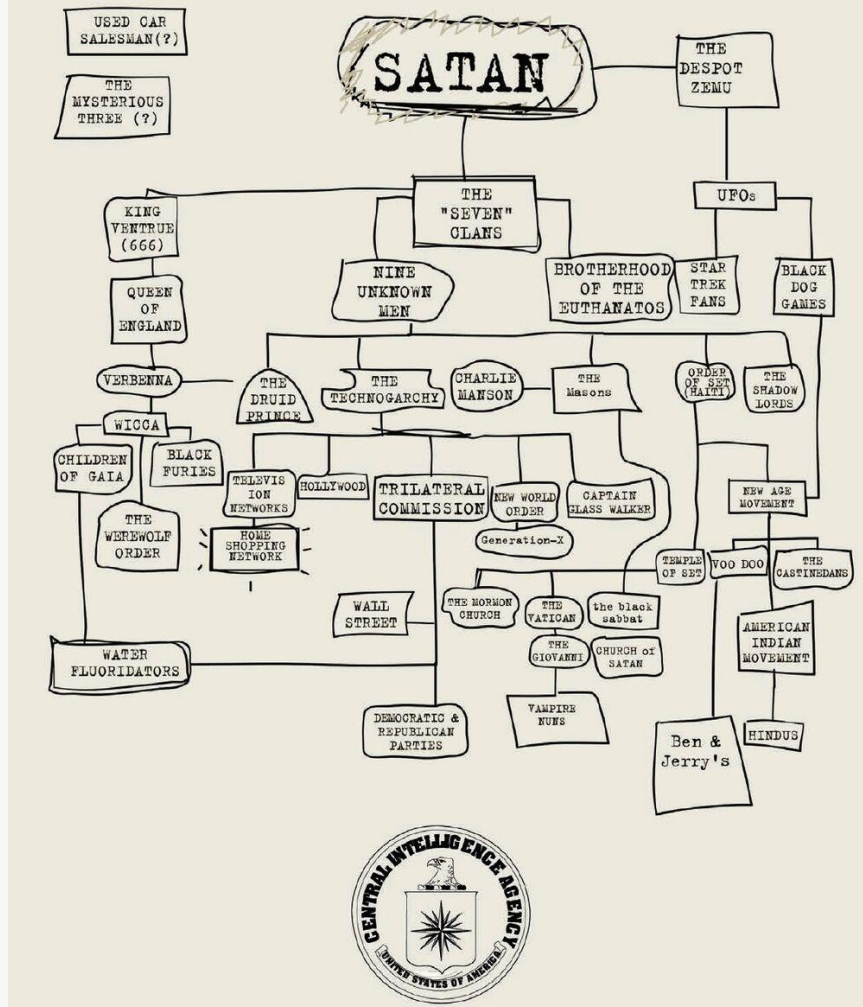
Aggravated Damage causes broken bones, wounds, and life-threatening injuries. Cutting and piercing weapons do Aggravated damage to humans, as does fire and firearms. Things like attacks from close friends and trusted figures do Aggravated damage to Willpower and may have a lasting effect on the target.

Desperation *(H:TR 5E Core Book p.125)*

Desperation increases when...	Desperation decreases when...
One or more of the Hunters suffers serious injury or death.	The Hunters managed to gain vital information about their quarry without increasing Danger.
The quarry managed to escape or advance their agenda despite the efforts of the cell.	The Hunters prevented the harming of innocents while accomplishing another objective.
The cell failed to prevent harm to innocents as a result of the actions of their quarry.	The Hunters managed to seriously harm or damage their quarry, directly or by proxy.



BOB SCHNOBLIN'S PYRAMID OF SATANIC POWER™



Credits and Disclaimer:

This is an open and free project by Chris Crowe. It is meant to serve as a companion to the core and source books of Hunter: The Reckoning and not to replace them. Portions of the materials are the copyrights and trademarks of White Wolf Entertainment AB, and are used with permission under the Dark Pack. All rights reserved.

For more information please visit worldofdarkness.com.

The information in this guide has been taken from the [Hunter: The Reckoning 5E Core Book](#).

Very special thanks to:

Birdy, Celi, and Domi for their artistic input, beautiful graphics, and listening to my mad ramblings at 4AM.

Good Luck, Hunters.